MERROWFIELD DIGITAL

Data Classification Standard

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1. Purpose

This standard names the categories of personal data Merrowfield Digital holds about customers and sellers, says which of them are high-impact, and defines the protection states the incident record uses. It is the vocabulary the desk and the Data Protection Officer use to judge harm.

2. Data categories

Category	Examples	High-impact
Contact details	Names, email addresses, phone numbers, delivery addresses	No
Account credentials	Passwords, password hashes, session tokens, recovery codes	Yes
Government ID	Seller identity documents and numbers collected for verification	Yes
Payment tokens	Tokenised references to cards and seller payout accounts	Yes
Health data	Order history that reveals health, such as pharmacy and medical-device orders	Yes
Children's accounts	Accounts and data of customers under 18	Yes

In words: contact details are personal data but not high-impact.

Account credentials are high-impact: they open other doors.

Government ID is high-impact: it enables identity fraud.

Payment tokens are high-impact, although a token alone cannot be spent.

Health data is high-impact and a special category of personal data.

Children's accounts are high-impact: children are owed extra protection.

3. Protection states

The incident record states how the data was protected when it was exposed.

Protection state	Meaning
Plaintext	Readable as it stands
Encrypted	Encrypted with a key that was not compromised: unintelligible to anyone who takes it
Encrypted key compromised	Encrypted, but the key was exposed with it or stored where the attacker could reach it
Pseudonymised	Direct identifiers replaced, but the data can still be linked back to a person
Hashed and salted	Passwords stored as salted hashes: slower to attack, but not unintelligible
Not applicable	No personal data was involved

Only the Encrypted state makes data unintelligible. Pseudonymised data can be linked back; hashed passwords can be cracked, and weak ones quickly; and encryption whose key was compromised protects nothing.

4. What raises the harm

The Data Protection Officer's judgement of harm, and the harm score that supports it, weigh the same things:

- which categories of data were involved, and whether any is high-impact
- how the data was protected
- whether exfiltration is confirmed - whether data is known to have left Merrowfield
- whether the attacker is still active
- how many people are affected

No single factor decides. Credentials in plaintext that were taken are among the most harmful combinations; a lost laptop whose disk was encrypted with a key that was not compromised is among the least.